

Chapter 30 - Video

Since there were only four people for lunch, Feng Yue didn't make too many dishes. She chose several dishes that everyone loved and some that each person liked, but even so, the table was set with about seven or eight dishes.

Feng Yue had almost memorized everyone's taste preferences: Wenzhen liked Cantonese cuisine¹, Zhou Qiongqiong preferred spicy food, and Fu Sixue didn't eat scallions or cilantro. Feng Yue had remembered all these details well.

Everyone sat around the dining table, and Wenzhen went to the kitchen to get the camera. She first took a good round of photos of the table full of dishes, then began filming Zhou Qiongqiong, Fu Sixue, and Feng Yue.

How should I put it? She had a bit of an occupational disease - whenever she held a camera and saw beautiful people or things, she always wanted to capture them. Even if everyone could appear in the footage, keeping these videos as mementos would be nice.

Seeing Wenzhen filming everyone, Zhou Qiongqiong also took out her phone to take photos, planning to post on social media later.

Fu Sixue had been hungry for a while and was now holding her chopsticks, waiting for everyone to finish filming so she could start eating.

Wenzhen was filming on the side, and Feng Yue couldn't sit still, so she moved closer to watch, occasionally asking questions, which Wenzhen answered one by one.

So among everyone at the dining table, only Fu Sixue, who had been hungry for ages, was seriously preparing to treat the food with respect.

She held her chopsticks with both hands, resting them on the bottom of her bowl, looking mournfully at this group of people who didn't respect food.

But as she watched, she noticed something wasn't quite right.

The atmosphere between Wenzhen and Moon seemed a bit off.

Fu Sixue squinted her eyes at the two people across from her, her brain rapidly analyzing the small gestures between them.

Fu Sixue had been much smarter than other children since childhood, and having a mature, quiet friend who was far beyond her peers in maturity had helped her become more accurate at reading people's thoughts through their subtle expressions and movements.

In addition, having lived abroad for a period, the open environment there had made her even more skilled at reading people's hearts.

Ah, if she wasn't mistaken, Wenzhen probably had some feelings for Moon. But Moon's behavior suggested she just saw the other person as an ordinary good friend.

Fu Sixue could understand Feng Yue. After all, she had just ended a twelve-year romantic relationship, so she definitely wouldn't be thinking about such things again in the short term, plus there was that sword named brain cancer constantly hanging over her head.

All these factors made it impossible for Feng Yue to accept another person without any reservations.

Fu Sixue squinted her eyes, a playful smile curving at the corner of her mouth.

Interesting, very interesting.

Fu Sixue put down her chopsticks, then picked up her phone from the side, gleefully sending a WeChat message to Yan Lin, who was far away at the company.

"Ah Lin, congratulations, you really do have a rival in love now."

After sending this message, Fu Sixue stopped looking at her phone, letting it ring occasionally.

After Fu Sixue finished this, everyone's filming work was almost coming to an end.

Feng Yue looked at the absolutely stunning appearances of Fu Sixue and Zhou Qiongqiong in the footage and suddenly didn't want to edit them out.

So Feng Yue asked for their opinions, "Xiaoxue, Qiongqiong, I'd like to include you two in the video, is that okay? Wenzhen made you both look too beautiful." She showed them the video.

In the video, Fu Sixue and Zhou Qiongqiong had sparkling eyes - one was bright and charming, the other cute and mischievous, looking indeed quite captivating.

Zhou Qiongqiong was originally a dance drama actress, so she didn't care about this aspect at all and generously agreed. Fu Sixue also had no concerns and nodded.

Hearing this, Feng Yue happily saved the video and marked this footage.

Everyone fussed around for a while before putting down what they were doing to prepare for the meal.

"Oh, wait. Should we drink something? I remember Xiaoxue brought wine." Zhou Qiongqiong asked after posting on social media.

"You all drink some, but I haven't been feeling well lately, so I'll substitute water for wine." Feng Yue prepared to stand up to get the wine and corkscrew.

"You sit, I'll get it." Wenzhen said, standing up and going into the kitchen.

Fu Sixue blinked her dark, round almond eyes and smiled, "Can Sister Wenzhen find the corkscrew and such?"

"She should know. When I was organizing the kitchen before, she was watching from the side."

Fu Sixue nodded without saying anything.

Wenzhen brought the items out and placed them on the table, then went to get the wine Fu Sixue had brought.

She looked at the label on the bottle and was somewhat surprised, "Romanée-Conti², it has quite a strong aftertaste. Should we drink it?"

"You brought such an expensive bottle of wine?" Feng Yue looked at Fu Sixue in surprise. Although she rarely drank alcohol, she had heard of this name.

Fu Sixue shrugged, "I just randomly picked it from my dad's wine cellar, I didn't know. But he has tons of wine in his cellar, taking one bottle won't matter."

"Well, since it's here, should we drink some?" Zhou Qiongqiong said.

"Let's drink. Since it has a strong aftertaste, we'll just drink a little, it won't matter. We don't have anything else to do today anyway." Fu Sixue said.

"Alright." With that, Wenzhen began opening the bottle, letting it breathe, and then pouring wine for everyone.

Soon, everyone raised their glasses together, and Feng Yue also raised her fruit juice, "Thank you all for coming to celebrate with me, cheers!"

"Cheers!"

The meal was enjoyed by all, and everyone became slightly tipsy from the wine, making their conversation much deeper than before.

Fortunately, there was still Feng Yue, the only one who hadn't drunk alcohol, barely controlling the conversation from drifting toward R-rated³ topics.

However, Fu Sixue's phone kept vibrating during this time, which she mostly ignored, until someone called her directly. Only then did she pick up her phone and temporarily leave the dining table for the balcony.

The wind from the balcony seemed to blow away the smell of alcohol from her body. She answered the call, "Hello."

"I'm downstairs."

Fu Sixue was stunned, then burst into joy, "Why aren't you coming up?"

Yan Lin said flatly, "You said my appearance would make her unhappy."

"Indeed." Fu Sixue turned around and looked through the transparent glass door of the balcony at the harmonious atmosphere at the dining table, "If you came up, you'd probably ruin her good mood for the day."

Yan Lin pressed her lips together, not wanting to continue this topic, and asked instead, "That rival in love is Wenzhen."

Her tone was very certain, without a trace of doubt.

Fu Sixue hadn't expected her to know so quickly, "You knew already?"

Yan Lin gripped the phone, closed her eyes and leaned back in her chair, "Not exactly knew already, but I encountered them once on the road before. I'm very familiar with how Wenzhen looks at Ayue - it's exactly how Ayue used to look at me."

"Tsk." Fu Sixue felt slightly irritated upon hearing this, "So what do you plan to do?"

"I don't know." Yan Lin honestly shook her head, opening her eyes to look at the tall building outside the car window. Somewhere in there lived the most important person to her.

"You're quite honest." Fu Sixue leaned against the balcony railing, saying flatly, "Take it slow. Ayue definitely won't accept Wenzhen in the short term."

"Mm."

"So you're planning to just wait downstairs all day?"

"Mm." Yan Lin glanced at the passenger seat where there were things she had brought, "I'm waiting for Shuangshuang⁴, I have something for her to give to Ayue."

"A housewarming gift?"

"Mm."

"In whose name?"

Yan Lin was silent for a while, "Shuangshuang's. She'll definitely like this gift, and I don't want to ruin her good mood."

"You're quite self-aware. If you knew this would happen, why did you do it in the first place?"

Yan Lin said nothing.

Fu Sixue had to change the subject and chat about other things before hanging up and returning to the dining room.

"Who was that? You talked for so long, we're almost finished eating." Zhou Qiongqiong asked curiously.

"Ah, work stuff, rushing me for drafts."

"Rushing for drafts?" Feng Yue was curious, "Do jewelry designers have deadlines too?"

When it came to work, Fu Sixue slumped against Zhou Qiongqiong's shoulder like she had no bones, "Yeah, we have to submit design drafts ahead of each quarter, and during holidays too. All year round I'm either drawing drafts or on my way to drawing drafts."

"If I didn't really love this work, who would suffer through this?"

Zhou Qiongqiong sympathetically patted her head, "Oh mama's good baby, you've worked hard. Come eat a bite of meat to recover." She fed Fu Sixue a piece of tender braised beef.

Fu Sixue puffed out her cheeks, chewed and swallowed, then regained her usual vitality.

After lunch, everyone helped clean up the kitchen and dining room, then sat around in the living room, setting up a table to play mahjong⁵.

Feng Yue's ancestors were from the Sichuan-Chongqing region, so her tastes and entertainment preferences leaned toward that area, and naturally her home was equipped with mahjong.

Although the other three didn't play much, they all knew how.

At first, Feng Yue relied on her skills acquired from being taken by her mother to various mahjong tables since childhood, and dominated the game.

But later she was completely outmaneuvered by Fu Sixue, who had "photographic memory" abilities.

However, Zhou Qiongqiong lost the most in the end. Both her arms and face had almost no clean spots left, covered with graffiti drawn by the other three using lipstick or eyeliner.

The other three also had some marks on their faces, but not as densely as Zhou Qiongqiong.

So when Dai Shuangshuang was welcomed in by Feng Yue, who was sporting a face full of graffiti, she thought she had arrived at some kind of body painting art exhibition.

Dai Shuangshuang looked like a Muggle who had mistakenly entered the magical world, surprised and confused as this group of women in their twenties with faces full of graffiti greeted her.

"Shuangshuang, what did you bring?" Fu Sixue, as Yan Lin's childhood friend, was naturally familiar with Dai Shuangshuang.

Hearing Fu Sixue's question, Dai Shuangshuang remembered she still had a mission. She handed the two boxes she brought toward Feng Yue, "Sister Yueyue, happy housewarming."

"Thank you, thank you, you really didn't need to bring any gifts."

"Open it and see, you should like it." Dai Shuangshuang looked expectant.

Feng Yue nodded and crouched down to unpack the larger box. When she opened it from the top, a rich fragrance immediately surrounded her nose, and what met her eyes were several blooming flowers.

Feng Yue stared at the rose bush in front of her, somewhat dazed. The light pink petals had edges that would gradually deepen in color as the growing time extended. Ruby-like crystalline red was now dotting the light pink petals.

If she wasn't mistaken, this rose bush was a new variety she had seen on a famous European rose breeding facility website some time ago. It had just been cultivated and didn't even have a specific name yet.

Shuangshuang would give her such a gift?

Footnotes:

1. **Cantonese cuisine (粤菜)** - One of the eight major Chinese cuisines, originating from Guangdong Province, known for its fresh ingredients and light flavors.
2. **Romanée-Conti** - One of the world's most expensive and prestigious wines from Burgundy, France.
3. **R-rated (限制级)** - Referring to adult/mature content that would be restricted for younger audiences.
4. **Shuangshuang (霜霜)** - A nickname for Dai Shuangshuang, using the doubled character as an affectionate diminutive.
5. **Mahjong (麻将)** - A traditional Chinese tile-based game commonly played by four players, very popular as a social activity in Chinese culture.